Opportunity Radar - Research Before You Invest

A complete evidence funnel for sectors, companies, funds, property and private opportunities.

MATRIX REPROGRAMMED - DETAILED WEALTH GUIDE

Reader outcome: Produce a sourced opportunity memo containing thesis, valuation, risks, alternatives, loss capacity and stop conditions.
Best for: A reader evaluating an opportunity who needs a disciplined research memo before committing money.
Edition checked: 2026-08-09

Educational information only. No personalised financial, investment, legal or tax advice. No guaranteed outcomes.

CONTENTS

1. The opportunity funnel

Screen broadly, investigate narrowly and commit only after the opportunity survives evidence, suitability, valuation and fraud checks.

Separate an attractive theme from an attractive security, property, business or contract.

Define the opportunity in one sentence without promotional language.

State the expected economic mechanism: who pays whom, why, when and from what cash source.

2. Step 1 - Suitability before excitement

State goal, time horizon, liquidity need, tax position, existing concentration and maximum tolerable loss.

Reject any opportunity that requires essential cash, emergency reserves or unaffordable leverage.

Record whether the asset can be valued and exited under stress.

Compare the opportunity with doing nothing, repaying debt and a diversified alternative.

3. Step 2 - Evidence hierarchy

Start with official product documents, audited accounts, regulator records, contracts, title records or tax documents.

Reconcile promotional claims against cash flow, balance sheet and legal rights.

Record missing documents as missing evidence, not as evidence of fraud or safety.

Verify identity, authorisation, custody and bank details independently.

4. Step 3 - Sector and demand

Define customer, problem, market size method, growth drivers, substitutes and cyclicality.

Ask whether demand is discretionary, regulated, subsidised, contractual or essential.

Identify the bottleneck and whether the opportunity truly owns or solves it.

Look for capacity expansion that may destroy pricing despite rising demand.

5. Step 4 - Business and cash economics

Trace revenue to gross profit, operating cash flow, capital expenditure, debt service and free cash flow.

Identify dilution, off-balance-sheet commitments, working-capital dependence and customer concentration.

For property, model vacancy, works, tax, insurance, finance and exit costs.

For private business, reconcile accounts to bank evidence and tax filings.

6. Step 5 - Management, control and incentives

Map voting control, board independence, compensation, related-party transactions and

6. Step 5 - Management, control and incentives (continued)

capital allocation history.
Do not infer competence from charisma or wealth.
Check whether management benefits when ordinary owners lose through dilution, fees or preferential rights.
Record key-person risk and succession.

7. Step 6 - Valuation is a condition

A good asset can be a poor purchase at an excessive price.
Use more than one valuation lens and show assumptions rather than presenting a single precise answer.
Stress revenue, margin, financing cost, exit multiple and time delay.
Compare expected return with a lower-cost diversified alternative after fees and tax.

8. Step 7 - Risk map

Market, credit, liquidity, operational, legal, tax, regulatory, technology, concentration, fraud and behavioural risk must be separate.
Rate probability, impact, detectability and mitigation for each material risk.
Identify risks that cannot be diversified or insured.
Write the maximum position or commitment consistent with loss capacity.

9. Pre-mortem and falsification

Assume the opportunity failed. Write the five most plausible causes.
For each cause, identify an early warning indicator and source.
Write what evidence would disprove the central thesis.
Set review dates based on information arrival, not price movement alone.

10. Investment memo template

[ ] One-sentence opportunity and economic mechanism.
[ ] Goal, horizon, liquidity and maximum loss.
[ ] Three primary sources.
[ ] Demand, competition and bottleneck.
[ ] Cash economics and balance-sheet risk.
[ ] Control, incentives and governance.
[ ] Valuation range and stress case.
[ ] Fraud and authorisation checks.
[ ] Alternatives considered.
[ ] Entry, monitoring, exit and stop rules.

11. How to use this guide

Purpose: Produce a sourced opportunity memo containing thesis, valuation, risks, alternatives, loss capacity and stop conditions.

11. How to use this guide (continued)

Best reader: A reader evaluating an opportunity who needs a disciplined research memo before committing money.
Read the guide once without taking action. On the second pass, complete the checklists and write down the evidence supporting each decision.
Replace every example number with your own verified amount, date, fee, tax treatment, contract term or source document.
Do not treat a checklist tick as proof. Keep copies of the underlying statements, quotations, filings, contracts and calculations.
For major decisions, use this guide to prepare better questions for a regulated adviser, accountant, lawyer, lender or insurer.

12. Evidence standard

Tier 1: law, regulator, tax authority, court, audited accounts, official product document or signed contract.
Tier 2: recognised institutional research that states its methodology, date and limitations.
Tier 3: reputable reporting used to identify questions, not to replace primary evidence.
Tier 4: marketing, social posts, testimonials, screenshots and anonymous claims. Treat these as unverified leads.
Write the source date beside every changing figure. A correct figure without a date can become misleading.
Separate facts, estimates, assumptions and scenarios. Never allow a scenario to be presented as a forecast or guarantee.
A company, fund, adviser, trust, structure, transaction or association is not proof of misconduct.

13. Decision record worksheet

[ ] State the decision in one sentence.
[ ] State the desired result and deadline.
[ ] List the three strongest pieces of supporting evidence.
[ ] List the three strongest reasons the decision may fail.
[ ] Record the maximum acceptable loss of money, time and flexibility.
[ ] Record the smallest reversible test.
[ ] Name the person responsible for checking legal, tax or regulatory consequences.
[ ] Set the next review date and the evidence that would cause you to stop.

14. Professional advice triggers

Seek regulated investment advice when product suitability, risk capacity, pensions, insurance or a large portfolio decision is unclear.
Seek tax advice before changing residence, extracting company cash, transferring

14. Professional advice triggers (continued)

assets, using trusts, gifting substantial sums or entering cross-border arrangements.

Seek legal advice before signing guarantees, shareholder agreements, acquisition contracts, complex leases, loan security or beneficiary arrangements.

Seek accounting advice when turnover, VAT, payroll, inventory, multiple activities or company-group transactions become material.

Use a defined written question. Paying for broad reassurance without documents or calculations rarely produces a useful answer.

15. Subject focus map

Use the following subject anchors as named checkpoints. For each checkpoint, record the fact, source, date, assumption, decision and next review date.

OPPORTUNITY FUNNEL: define what this checkpoint means for this guide, what evidence supports it, and what result would cause you to change course.

PRE-MORTEM: define what this checkpoint means for this guide, what evidence supports it, and what result would cause you to change course.

VALUATION IS A CONDITION: define what this checkpoint means for this guide, what evidence supports it, and what result would cause you to change course.

INVESTMENT MEMO: define what this checkpoint means for this guide, what evidence supports it, and what result would cause you to change course.

Do not mark a checkpoint complete because an action was taken. Mark it complete only when the result and supporting evidence have been recorded.

Where a checkpoint depends on another person, institution, platform or contract, record that dependency and a fallback route.

Rank checkpoints by potential harm if ignored, not by how interesting or easy they appear.

At the end of each review, choose one checkpoint to advance and one risk to reduce before adding a new objective.

16. Worked decision case

Write a real decision from your own situation at the top of a blank page. Examples include changing work, launching an offer, choosing an account, buying an asset, restructuring a business or rejecting a proposal.

Baseline: state the current cash, income, liabilities, commitments, ownership, legal position and time available. Use documents rather than memory where possible.

Desired result: describe the measurable outcome, deadline and reason. Remove vague language such as more, better, passive, safe or guaranteed.

Options: include the proposed action, a smaller reversible test, a diversified alternative, delaying the action and doing nothing.

Evidence: attach at least three independent sources. Identify which evidence is official, contractual, audited, estimated, promotional or missing.

Economics: show setup cost, recurring cost, cash timing, fees, tax reserve, downside loss, opportunity cost and the point at which the decision becomes worthwhile.

16. Worked decision case (continued)

Risk: identify concentration, liquidity, legal, operational, fraud, health, relationship and behavioural risks. Name the risk that could create irreversible harm.
Professional review: write the exact question that requires an accountant, lawyer, regulated adviser, lender, insurer or technical specialist.
Decision: state proceed, test, delay or reject. Record the maximum commitment and the evidence required before any further commitment.
Review: set a dated checkpoint. Write the result that would confirm the decision, the result that would require adjustment and the result that would trigger an immediate stop.

17. 90-day implementation workbook

Week 1 - Establish the baseline. Reconcile the relevant accounts, contracts, statements, fees, tax records, responsibilities and deadlines.
Week 2 - Define the result. Choose one measurable outcome and remove actions that do not directly support it or protect an essential risk.
Week 3 - Gather primary evidence. Use official registers, filings, signed terms, current quotations and dated institutional data.
Week 4 - Compare alternatives. Include a lower-cost option, a lower-risk option, a reversible test and the option to wait.
Week 5 - Model the economics. Build downside, base and upside cases while treating every uncertain input as an assumption.
Week 6 - Verify identity and authority. Confirm who owns, controls, advises, holds money, signs contracts and bears liability.
Week 7 - Run the smallest useful test. Limit money, time and legal commitment while collecting evidence about real demand or performance.
Week 8 - Reconcile actual results. Compare promised, expected and actual cost, time, cash flow, quality, risk and customer or counterparty behaviour.
Week 9 - Repair the constraint. Improve the single factor currently limiting income, retention, safety, liquidity, delivery or evidence quality.
Week 10 - Install controls. Add calendar reminders, approval limits, account separation, written procedures, backups and review ownership.
Week 11 - Decide whether to scale. Increase commitment only when the test produced measurable value and the downside remains affordable.
Week 12 - Complete the evidence file. Store the decision record, sources, calculations, contracts, results, lessons and next review date.
Day 90 - Write a one-page conclusion: what was established, what remains uncertain, what changed, what will continue and what will stop.

18. Review, escalation and stop rules

Review monthly when the decision affects recurring cash, debt, customer commitments, investment contributions or essential protection.
Review immediately after a material legal change, tax notice, contract change,

18. Review, escalation and stop rules (continued)

security incident, missed payment, large loss, health event or relationship change.
Escalate to a qualified professional when the facts cross jurisdictions, involve regulated products, create personal guarantees, affect beneficiaries or cannot be reversed cheaply.
Pause when required documents are missing, identities cannot be independently verified, costs are unclear or the counterparty resists reasonable due diligence.
Stop when the action requires deception, undeclared income, false invoices, hidden beneficial ownership, unaffordable leverage or essential-living money.
Stop when actual cash use, delivery time or loss exceeds the written limit.
Stop when the central evidence is corrected, withdrawn, contradicted by a stronger source or no longer current.
Do not move a stop limit merely because money, pride or time has already been committed. Sunk cost is not evidence that continuing is rational.
Record every exception to the plan, who approved it and why. Repeated exceptions indicate the plan or control is not working.
A stopped action can still be a successful decision when it prevents a larger loss and preserves the ability to act later.

19. Evidence and legal boundary

This is educational information, not personalised financial, investment, legal, accounting or tax advice.
Investments can fall in value. Businesses can fail. Debt, leverage, illiquidity, tax and legal obligations can create losses greater than the expected benefit.
Rules and thresholds change. Verify the current official position on the date of action.
Never use false invoices, hidden ownership, undeclared income, sham transactions, misleading applications or borrowed essential-living money.
No return, saving, valuation, tax outcome or business result is guaranteed.

20. Official research routes

1. AMF - Verify an authorisation - https://www.amf-france.org/fr/espace-epargnants/proteger-son-epargne/faire-les-verifications
2. ESMA investor information - https://www.esma.europa.eu/investor-corner
3. SEC EDGAR - https://www.sec.gov/edgar/search/
4. European Central Bank statistics - https://data.ecb.europa.eu/
5. Eurostat - https://ec.europa.eu/eurostat/
6. Banque de France - https://www.banque-france.fr/